

Task 4 — Make It Portable

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PROJECT TITLE AND WHAT IT DOES

The same Skill, a second surface. Proves weekly-study-notes survives outside the chat that built it — that it is a reusable asset and not a one-time trick. The claim being tested: a Skill is just a folder with a text file in it — a name, a description, plain-English instructions. Nothing in that is tied to Claude.ai. Anthropic published the **Agent Skills open standard** (agentskills.io) in December 2025 and the format now reads across tools, so the same folder should simply work somewhere else. This task checks whether that is true in practice.

AI TOOLS AND APPS USED

TOOL	ROLE
Claude.ai	Original surface — where the skill was built and first run
Claude Code	Second surface — the portability target
weekly-study-notes	The skill under test — unchanged , not rewritten for the new surface

THE PROMPT I USED

Make study notes from this: [class_notes_thesis.md]

The same natural request I use in Claude.ai. Nothing about the format was re-explained — that is the point. If the skill needs a briefing to work on a second surface, it is not portable; it is just a document I am pasting around.

WHAT CAME BACK

Input was class_notes_thesis.md, the same Agent Factory Thesis source as Task 3. Output was agent-factory-notes.html, titled *The Agent Factory — Study Blueprint*. The skill invented its own 14-topic split — different from the 10-sheet split the same skill produced in Claude.ai, which is expected: the skill specifies *how* to group topics, not *which* topics exist.

HOW I TESTED AND VERIFIED IT

I checked the Claude Code output line by line against my own SKILL.md spec, rather than just eyeballing whether it "looked right":

SPEC REQUIREMENT	RESULT	DETAIL
Card per topic, self-invented titles	Held	14 cards, own topic split
Tap-to-reveal key terms	Held	Reveal mechanic present and working
Exactly 3 scored questions	Held	Quiz present with explanations
No localStorage / sessionStorage	Held	Zero occurrences — state in JS variables
prefers-reduced-motion respected	Held	Media query present
All controls are real <button> elements	Dropped	Terms rendered as <div class="term"> with click listeners — only 4 real buttons in the file

WHAT WORKED, WHAT DID NOT, AND PROBLEMS I FACED

What worked

- The skill survived the move.** Same file, different surface, no re-explaining — the core format came back intact.
- The content rules ported perfectly.** Topic invention, term count, quiz length, the reveal mechanic, and the quality-floor items I had pinned (localStorage, reduced-motion) all held without a single reminder.
- This is what makes a Skill different from a Custom GPT or a Gem.** Those are powerful but live only inside their own product — you cannot take one elsewhere. A Skill is a folder, and folders travel.

What did not work — the finding of this task

One instruction was silently dropped. My SKILL.md says plainly: "*all controls are real <button> elements.*" Claude.ai honours it. Claude Code rendered the tap-to-reveal terms as <div> elements with click listeners attached — visually identical, functionally similar, but not keyboard-focusable and invisible to a screen reader. Nothing announced this. The artifact looked correct. I only found it because I grepped the output against my own spec instead of trusting my eyes — **which is the same verification habit Task 2 and Task 3 were teaching, applied to a skill instead of a connector.**

This is the course's caveat proven in my own hands rather than quoted from the reading: **a basic SKILL.md travels across skills-compatible tools, but each product adds its own install path, invocation syntax, and permissions on top. The core is portable; the edges differ.** Here the edge was an accessibility instruction that one surface enforces and another treats as a suggestion.

Problems faced

- The output arrives differently.** Claude.ai renders an inline artifact; Claude Code writes an .html file to disk that I open myself. The skill produces the same thing — the surface decides what happens to it. Not a failure, but it means "it worked" means something slightly different on each surface.
- Verifying portability is harder than claiming it.** "It ran and looked right" is not proof. The <button> deviation would have passed any visual check. The only reliable test was reading the output against the spec I wrote — which suggests that for any skill worth porting, the spec needs to be specific enough to check against mechanically.